

SKOAR

Metal Gear Rising: Revengeance and Sniper Ghost Warrior 2 go under the scanner this month

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Money, money, money... MONEY!!!

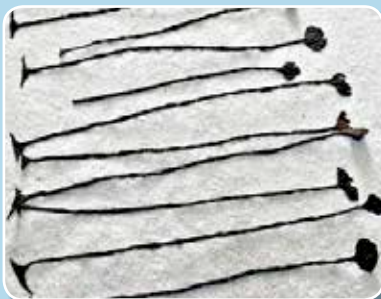
That headline's just a hat-tip to Donald Trump (remember him from The Apprentice?), we just couldn't resist ourselves given the topic of this month's feature: Weird money. That's right. Types of moolah that will make your head spin; or at least pique your interest. Ka-ching.

**Rai money**

The Yap islands in the Pacific have a tradition of large (12ft in diameter, 1.5ft thickness and about 4000 kg), doughnut shaped calcite stones that are used as "coins". We know that sounds crazy, but then what else did you expect? Tribals of these islands still trade one of these humungous stones submerged in sea. Wonder how big their pockets are?

Kissi money

People at Liberia used twisted iron rods with flattened ends of different lengths (9 to 15 inches) as "soul" money. The interesting part is that if it accidentally broke, it would no longer be circulated as the soul was said to have escaped. The rod is trash unless a witchdoctor would reincarnate the escaped soul. Voodoo Mama Juju!

**Cocaine money**

Ever wondered if drugs were exchanged as money – not for money? It used to happen at Guerima, a remote Colombian settlement which had to resort to paying for food by bags of coca. The story goes that the town had so much of coca that they couldn't care less about trading it for groceries. One gram would be enough to buy a soft drink. Yikes!

**Tea bricks**

High density bricks made of whole or powdered tea were used as currency all over Central Asia till late WWII. Seriously, no kidding. The region was well known for its tea production – and apparently extended tea breaks, too. Come to think of it, a practical currency that could be broken and eaten in a time of crisis does make sense, right?

Quid

If you found yourself travelling between planets you won't be able to survive on traveller's cheques. You'd need some Quid coins. They're rounded and smooth to reduce damage in a zero gravity environment. How else would you ensure you have a high-tech currency term (or object) that you can trade with once you jet off to Andromeda? Fuel ain't cheap.

**Coins don't have to be round**

They can be the shape of a country too. Zambia in 2000 released coins of the shape of north Australia fused with north Zambia to commemorate the Sydney Olympics. As creative as that might be, they should've thought twice about representing Australia, which is ten times the size of Zambia, approximately the same size as the coin.